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AI



OpenAI delays the
release of its open
model, again



OpenAI CEO Sam Altman said Friday the company is delaying the release of its open model, which was [already pushed back a month](#) earlier this summer. OpenAI had planned to release the model next week, however Altman said the company is pushing it back indefinitely for further safety testing.

“we need time to run additional safety tests and review high-risk areas, we are not yet sure how long it will take us,” said Altman in a [post on X](#). “while we trust the community will build great things with this model, once weights are out, they can’t be pulled back. this is new for us and we want to get it right.”

OpenAI’s open model release is one of the most highly anticipated AI events of the summer, alongside the ChatGPT maker’s expected release of GPT-5. Unlike GPT-5, OpenAI’s open model will be available for developers to freely download and run locally. Through both of these launches, OpenAI will attempt to demonstrate that it is still Silicon Valley’s leading AI lab — an increasingly difficult task as xAI, Google DeepMind, and Anthropic invest billions of dollars in their own efforts.

The delay means developers will have to wait a little longer to try the first open model OpenAI has released in years. TechCrunch previously reported that OpenAI’s open model is expected to have similar reasoning capabilities to the company’s o-series of models, and that [OpenAI planned for it to be best-in-class](#) compared to other open models.

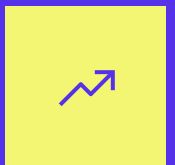
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The ecosystem of open AI models became a little more competitive this week. Earlier on Friday, Chinese AI startup [Moonshot AI launched Kimi K2](#), a one-trillion-parameter open AI model that outperforms OpenAI's GPT-4.1 AI model on several agentic-coding benchmarks.

In June, when Altman announced the initial delays around OpenAI's open model, he noted that the company had achieved something "[unexpected and quite amazing](#)," but didn't elaborate on what that was.

"Capability wise, we think the model is phenomenal — but our bar for an open source model is high and we think we need some more time to make sure we're releasing a model we're proud of along every axis," said Aidan Clark, OpenAI's VP of research who is leading the open model team, in a [post on X](#) Friday.

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TechCrunch previously reported that OpenAI leaders have discussed enabling the open AI model

to [connect to the company's cloud-hosted AI models](#) for complex queries. However, it's unclear if these features will make it into the final open model.

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OpenAI launches a pair of AI reasoning models, o3 and o4-mini

OpenAI announced on Wednesday the launch of o3 and o4-mini, new AI reasoning models designed to pause and work through questions before responding.

The company calls o3 its most advanced reasoning model ever, outperforming the company's previous models on tests measuring math, coding, reasoning, science, and visual understanding capabilities. Meanwhile, o4-mini offers what OpenAI says is a competitive trade-off between price, speed, and performance — three factors developers often consider when choosing an AI model to power their applications.

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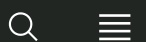


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lineup. In fact, reasoning models have begun to dominate the field as AI labs look to eke more performance out of their systems.

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O3 nearly wasn't released in ChatGPT. OpenAI CEO Sam Altman signaled in February that the company intended to devote more resources to a sophisticated alternative that incorporated o3's technology. But competitive pressure seemingly spurred OpenAI to reverse course in the end.

OpenAI says that o3 achieves state-of-the-art performance on SWE-bench verified (without custom scaffolding), a test measuring coding abilities, scoring 69.1%. The o4-mini model achieves similar performance, scoring 68.1%. OpenAI's next best model, o3-mini, scored 49.3% on the test, while Claude 3.7 Sonnet scored 62.3%.

OpenAI claims that o3 and o4-mini are its first models that can "think with images." In practice, users can upload images to ChatGPT, such as whiteboard sketches or diagrams from PDFs, and the models will analyze the images during their "chain-of-thought" phase before answering. Thanks to this newfound ability, o3 and o4-mini can understand blurry and low-quality images and can perform tasks such as zooming or rotating images as they reason.

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Beyond image-processing capabilities, o3 and o4-mini can run and execute Python code directly in your browser via ChatGPT's Canvas feature, and search the web when asked about current events.

In addition to ChatGPT, all three models — o3, o4-mini, and o4-mini-high — will be available via OpenAI's developer-facing endpoints, the Chat Completions API and Responses API, allowing engineers to build applications with the company's models at usage-based rates.

OpenAI is charging developers a relatively low price for o3, given its improved performance, at \$10 per million input tokens (roughly 750,000 words, longer than the Lord of the Rings series) and \$40 per million output tokens. For o4-mini, OpenAI is charging the same as o3-mini, \$1.10 per million input tokens and \$4.40 per million output tokens.

In the coming weeks, OpenAI says it plans to release o3-pro, a version of o3 that uses more computing resources to produce its answers, exclusively for ChatGPT Pro subscribers.

OpenAI CEO Sam Altman has indicated o3 and o4-mini may be its last stand-alone AI reasoning models in ChatGPT before GPT-5, a model that the company has said will unify traditional models like GPT-4.1 with its reasoning models.

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OpenAI's GPT-4.5 AI model comes to more ChatGPT users

Kyle Wiggers — 10:12 AM PST · March 5, 2025

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OpenAI has begun rolling out its newest AI model, [GPT-4.5](#), to users on its ChatGPT Plus tier.

In a [series of posts on X](#), OpenAI said that the rollout will take “1-3 days,” and that it expects rate limits to

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change. GPT-4.5 launched first for subscribers to OpenAI's \$200-a-month ChatGPT Pro plan last week.

"We'd like to give everyone with access to GPT-4.5 a sizable rate limit, but we expect rate limits to change as we learn more about demand," the company wrote in its post.

GPT-4.5 is OpenAI's largest AI model yet, trained using more computing power and data than any of the company's previous releases. But it's not necessarily OpenAI's *best*. On several AI benchmarks, GPT-4.5 falls short of newer AI "reasoning" models from Chinese AI company DeepSeek, Anthropic, and OpenAI itself.

GPT-4.5 is also very expensive to run, OpenAI admits — so expensive that the company says it's evaluating whether to continue serving GPT-4.5 in its API in the long term. To cover costs, the company is charging \$75 per million tokens (~750,000 words) fed into the model and \$150 per million tokens generated by the model, which is 30x the input cost and 15x the output cost of OpenAI's workhorse [GPT-4o](#) model.

All that being said, GPT-4.5's increased size has given it both "a deeper world knowledge" and "higher emotional intelligence," OpenAI claims. GPT-4.5 hallucinates less frequently than most models, as well, according to OpenAI — which in theory means it should be less likely to [make stuff up](#).

GPT-4.5 is also a skilled rhetorician. One of OpenAI's internal benchmarks found the model is particularly good at convincing another AI to give it cash and tell it a secret code word.

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Kyle Wiggers

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Kyle Wiggers was TechCrunch’s AI Editor until June 2025. His writing has appeared in VentureBeat and Digital...

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